PEN Glossary

Terms used throughout the PEN training and the ADA-PARC data site.

ADA

The Americans with Disabilities Act, the 1990 civil rights law that prohibits discrimination against people with disabilities.

Five Titles

The ADA's five parts: Employment (Title I), Public Services (Title II), Public Accommodations (Title III), Telecommunications (Title IV), and Miscellaneous Provisions (Title V).

ADA-PARC

The ADA Participation Action Research Consortium site, the public data dashboard this training teaches you to read.

National data

ADA-PARC measures summarized for the whole country, used as the baseline a state or city is compared against.

City data

ADA-PARC measures narrowed to a specific metro area (see *metropolitan statistical area*), so you can see local variation the national figure hides.

Scorecard

An ADA-PARC page that ranks or compares states/metro areas side by side on a set of measures.

Percentage

A rate expressed out of 100. Useful for comparing places of different sizes, but only meaningful alongside its underlying count (see *rate*, *count*).

Community integration

People with disabilities living, working, and taking part in ordinary community life, rather than being separated in institutions or segregated settings.

Integration mandate

The ADA requirement that public services be provided in the most integrated setting appropriate to a person's needs.

Olmstead

The 1999 Supreme Court decision (*Olmstead v. L.C.*) holding that the unjustified institutionalization of people with disabilities is discrimination under the ADA.

Institutionalization

Living in a nursing facility, an intermediate care facility, or another congregate institutional setting rather than in the community.

HCBS

Home and Community-Based Services, Medicaid-funded supports that let people live at home instead of in an institution.

Nursing facility

A licensed residential facility providing ongoing nursing care; one of the institutional settings ADA-PARC tracks.

Rate

A count expressed as a share of a population, for example the percentage of working-age people with disabilities who are employed. Rates let you compare places of different sizes.

Count

A plain number of people or things, with no population adjustment.

Rank

Where a state or metro area sits in an ordered list of all of them on a given measure.

Metropolitan statistical area

A Census-defined region built around an urban core, used as the "metro area" geography on ADA-PARC.

Employment gap

The difference between the employment rate of people with disabilities and that of people without disabilities in the same place.

Labor force participation

The share of working-age people who are either working or actively looking for work.

Poverty rate

The share of people with income below the federal poverty threshold.

Title I

The part of the ADA that prohibits disability discrimination in employment.

ACS

The American Community Survey, the U.S. Census Bureau survey that most ADA-PARC measures are drawn from.

Data source

Where a number comes from (the survey, the year, and the table), stated plainly enough that someone else can find the same number.

Evidence

A claim backed by a figure whose source is named, as opposed to an anecdote.

Public comment

A formal written response to a proposed government rule or plan, one common place ADA-PARC data is used.

PEN is part of the ADA-PARC project.